

LESSON - 4

THE MOUNTAIN AND THE SQUIRREL

Session - 1



PRE-READING

I

- Socialisation :
- Look at the picture below. Can you name them? Can they talk like human beings? Do you think they show themselves off? We people do so. Now let us read a poem how an object and a creature in the poem talk like human beings to show themselves off.

II

WHILE-READING

- *Your teacher reads the poem aloud first and you listen to him/her with your books closed.*
- *Your teacher reads the poem aloud for the second time and you listen to him/her and follow the poem in your book.*
- *Now read the poem silently and answer the questions that follow.*

TEXT



The mountain and the squirrel
Had a quarrel;
And the former called the latter 'Little Prig.'
Bun replied,
"You are doubtless very big ;
But all sorts of weather
Must be taken in together,
To make up a year
And a sphere.
And I think it no disgrace
To occupy my place.
If I'm not as large as you,
You are not as small as I,
And not half so spry.
I'll not deny you make
A very pretty squirrel track;
Talents differ; all is well and wisely put;
If I cannot carry forests on my back,
Neither can you crack a nut."

Ralph Waldo Emerson

- **Comprehension questions:**

1. What is the poem about ?
2. Who had a quarrel ?
3. What does 'the former' refer to? And 'the latter' ?
4. Who started the quarrel ?
5. Who called whom "Little Prig" ?
6. Did the squirrel take it easy ?
7. How did he feel about it ?
8. What makes up a year ?
9. What makes up the sphere ?

10. Does the squirrel feel inferior to be a tiny creature ?
Which line tells this ?
11. The mountain is big. What can it do and what cannot ?
12. The squirrel is small. What can it do and what cannot ?
13. Who does 'I' in the last two lines refer to ?
14. How are they different from each other ?
15. What do you mean by 'all is well' ?
16. 'Wisely put' means _____
17. Who talks more in the poem ?
Do you think he is a little bit quarrelsome ?
18. Do we find such people among us ?
19. Who of the two do you like more ? why ?
20. Find the rhyming words in the poem ?

Session - 2

III

POST-READING

1 Visual Memory Development Technique (VMDT) :

- Whole Text : Picture of the mountain , squirrel , squirrel track in it
The title of the poem
Little prig- And I think it no disgrace-Talents differ- Neither
can you crack a nut
- Part : Stanza-2 - disgrace –occupy my place –large-small-
deny- pretty – squirrel track – talents- carry forests- crack a
nut

2 Comprehension Activities :

(a) MCQs : Complete the sentences choosing the correct options.

1. 'And I think it no disgrace to occupy my place' means _____
A. nothing in the world has any value.
B. everything in the world has no value.
C. one should not feel inferior to others.
D. one should think himself to be superior to others.

2. The squirrel has the talent to _____
- A. speak less
 - B. crack a nut
 - C. carry forests on its back
 - D. move a mountain
3. 'Disgrace' means _____
- A. an insult
 - B. admiring others
 - C. saying good of others
 - D. being good to others

(b) Match the words under 'A' with the words under 'B'.

Write (1) or (2) in brackets before the words under 'B'.

A	B
(1) Mountain	() small
	() big
	() little prig
	() not active
	() cannot carry forests
(2) Squirrel	() can crack a nut
	() can carry forests
	() cannot crack a nut
	() cannot make a squirrel track

Session - 3

3 Listening:

- (a) Your teacher reads aloud the following text. You listen to him/her and fill in the gaps.

One day a _____ and a _____ had a _____. The mountain called the squirrel '_____.'

In reply the squirrel said to him, "You are very _____ but I'm very _____. I'm _____ active but you are not. I can _____ a nut but you cannot. You can carry _____ on your back but I cannot."

- (b) Your teacher dictates some words from the list given below. Listen to him/her and tick those words.

4 Speaking:

- (b) Practise the following dialogue.

Mountain : You, little prig.

Mountain : I can carry forests on my back but you can't.

Session - 4

There are eight words in this word-puzzle. Find them using the clues given.

Clues :

1. The small creature in this poem - _____
2. An angry argument - _____
(The squirrel and the mountain had it)
3. It can carry forests on its back - _____
4. The opposite of 'small' - _____
5. It means the earth - _____
6. It means 'insult' - _____
7. It means 'abilities' - _____
8. Without doubt - _____

6 Usage :

- (a) The poet uses 'as as' with 'not' in the poem. They are used to compare the qualities of two objects or persons. Use the same expressions to combine sentences. One is done for you.

- (i) The mountain is big.

The squirrel is not so big.

Ans- The squirrel is not as big as the mountain.

- (ii) Ramesh is rich.

Hari is not so rich.

- (iii) Malati is intelligent .

Surabhi is not so intelligent.

- (iv) Pratik is hardworking.

Naresh is not so hardworking.

- (v) Mani is beautiful.

Priyanka is not so beautiful.

- (vi) Gopal is clever.

Krishna is not so clever.

- (b) The poem makes it clear what the squirrel can do and what it cannot. It also tells us what the mountain can do and what it cannot.

For example;

The squirrel can crack a nut. It cannot carry forests on its back.

The mountain can carry forests on its back .It cannot crack a nut.

Using the expressions given below, write some sentences on your best friend using 'can or cannot'.

Expressions:

climb a mountain, catch a squirrel , sing a song , solve a word-puzzle, ride a bike , lift a heavy bag, compose a poem , play the guitar, play badminton

Some helps are given .

My best friend is _____. S/He can _____
 _____ . S/He cannot _____

- (c) Rewrite the pairs of sentences by connecting them with 'but'. One is done for you.

Q. My friend, Amrita can sing a song. She cannot ride a bike.

Ans. My friend, Amrita can sing a song but cannot ride a bike.

Q. Nandita can do sums. She cannot speak English well.

Ans. _____

Q. Prabal can dance. he cannot box.

Ans. _____

Q. Rabindra can drive a car. He cannot ride a cycle.

Ans. _____

Q. Pratap can speak well. He cannot sing songs.

Ans. _____

7 Writing :

Answer the following questions.

(i) Who had a quarrel ?

(ii) What did the mountain call the squirrel ?

(iii) What must be taken together to make up a year and a sphere ?

(iv) How many times does the mountain talk in the poem ?

(v) What can the squirrel do ?

(vi) What can the mountain do ?

(vii) The mountain and the squirrel do not have the same abilities. Do we have people like them ?

(viii) Who do you like in this poem – the mountain or the squirrel ?

8 Mental Talk :

Mentally repeat the following sentence.

“Talents differ.”

9 Think :

“Talents differ.” Should we quarrel over it?



FOLLOW- UP LESSON:

DAY AND NIGHT

Session - 1

I

PRE-READING

- Socialisation :
- Your teacher asks:
 1. What does the day bring for you?
 2. What does the night bring for you?
 3. Who brings you better things- the day or the night?

Now let's read a poem to know all these.

II

WHILE-READING

- Your teacher reads the poem aloud. You listen to him/her closing your book.
- S/He reads it for the second time. You listen to him/her opening your book.
- Read the poem silently and answer the questions that follow.

TEXT

Said the Day to Night
'I bring God's light.

What gifts have you?'
Night said, 'the dew.'

'I give bright hours,'
Said Day, 'and flowers.'

Said Night more blest,
'I bring sweet rest.'



Lady Lindsay

- **Comprehension Questions:**

1. What is the poem about ?
2. Who asks questions in the poem ?
3. Who answers them ?
4. Who brings God's light ?
5. Who brings dew ?
6. Which one is more important - flower or rest ?
7. Who brings you better things - Day or Night ?
8. Who thinks s/he brings better things - Day or Night ?
9. Who according to you is a male - Day or Night ?

III

POST-READING

Session - 2

1 Speaking :

- (a) Chain-drill: "Day brings bright hours and Night brings sweet rest."
- (b) Practise the dialogue given below.

[Teacher vs. students, students vs. students and finally in pairs]

Day : I bring God's light.

What gifts have you?

Night : I bring dew.

Day : I give bright hours and flowers.

What about you?

Night : I bring sweet rest.

2 Writing :

Answer the following questions.

- (i) Who asks questions in this poem?

(ii) Who brings God's light?

(iii) Who brings rest? What is it like?

(iv) Which one is more important – flower or rest?

(v) Which word is used more in this poem- Day or Night? Does the poet give it more importance by using the word more often?

(vi) Who in the poem thinks himself/herself to be superior?

WORD NOTE

(The words / phrases have been defined mostly on contextual meanings.)

blest (bless) (adj)	-	someone blessed by God (with more thing), ଅଧିକ ବିଭବ ବା ଶକ୍ତି ପାଇଥିବା ବ୍ୟକ୍ତି
bun (n)	-	squirrel, ଗୁଣ୍ଡୁଚିମୂଷା
crack (v)	-	break, ଭାଙ୍ଗିବା
dew (n)	-	some drops of water seen on grass, କାକର, ଶିଶିର
disgrace (n)	-	shame, below the dignity, ଲଜ୍ୟା ବା ନ୍ୟୁନ ମନେକରିବା
little prig (n)	-	a little proud creature, (squirrel), ଗର୍ବ ଦେଖାଉଥିବା କ୍ଷୁଦ୍ର ପ୍ରାଣୀ
occupy (v)	-	to hold (my place), ଯେଉଁସ୍ଥାନରେ ଅଛି ଠିକ୍ ଅଛି, ସ୍ଥାନ ନେବା
quarrel (n)	-	angry arguments, କଳି
sphere (n)	-	(here) the world, ସାମଗ୍ରିକ ଭୂମଣ୍ଡଳ, ପୃଥିବୀ
spry (adj)	-	full of life and energy, ଜୀବନ୍ତ, ଚଳଚଞ୍ଚଳ